

Orbit Digital

Thirty years in public libraries

Replacement of the Library Management System

Greenfield City Library Service operates a central library and eleven branch libraries serving approximately 184,000 registered members. The present library management system was commissioned in 2006, is no longer supported by its original vendor, and cannot support self-service borrowing, online renewals, or consolidated reporting across branches. The Service invites proposals for a replacement covering catalogue management, membership, circulation (borrowing, returns, renewals, reservations), inter-branch transfers, overdue fines, and public search.

Submitted to	Greenfield City Library Service
RFP reference	GCLS/RFP/2026/014
Submission date	2026-09-10
Proposed duration	8 months

FICTIONAL DOCUMENT -- prepared for an academic exercise. Greenfield City Library Service, the suppliers and all references named in this document are invented. No real organisation is described.

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

Orbit Digital has worked with public library services since 1996. In that time we have replaced 61 library management systems, including nineteen migrations from the product family Greenfield City Library Service currently operates. We know what the Service is dealing with, because we have dealt with it before.

We understand the requirement as set out in GCLS/RFP/2026/014: catalogue, membership, circulation, reservations, inter-branch transfers, fines and public search across twelve sites and 184,000 members. Our proposal reflects three decades of pattern recognition about how these programmes succeed and, more usefully, how they fail.

- 61 library management system replacements since 1996
- 19 prior migrations from the Service's current product family
- Dedicated public libraries practice, 55 staff, not a general IT team
- Reference sites available for visits, including two within 40 miles

2. Proposed Solution and Technical Approach

Orbit Library Platform is a mature product, currently on version 11, used by 61 library services. It covers catalogue management to MARC 21 and RDA standards, membership, circulation, reservations and inter-branch transfer, fines and charges, acquisitions, serials, and a public discovery interface. The functional coverage required by the Service is met by the product as it stands, with configuration rather than development.

The platform is deployed on cloud infrastructure managed by Orbit Digital. Capacity is sized from our experience of comparable services; a detailed sizing exercise forms part of project initiation.

On integration, our approach is to establish the appropriate mechanism during the design phase. We have extensive experience of connecting to RFID equipment, payment providers and authentication systems across our client base, and we will work with the Service and its incumbent suppliers to agree and implement suitable interfaces. The specific technical approach will depend on the configuration of the existing estate, which we would expect to survey during initiation. Our integration services line in the commercial section carries an allowance for this work based on typical requirements at services of comparable size.

- Mature product at version 11, in service at 61 library authorities
- MARC 21 and RDA compliant cataloguing
- Functional requirements met by configuration rather than development
- Integration mechanisms to be determined during the design phase following a survey of the existing estate

3. Implementation Plan, Team and Milestones

Eight months, following our standard implementation methodology refined across 61 deployments.

Phase	Weeks	Key deliverable	Lead role
1. Initiation	1-5	Project plan, estate survey, sizing	Project Manager
2. Design and configuration	6-16	Configured platform, design document	Principal Consultant
3. Data migration	12-24	Migrated catalogue and member data	Migration Specialist
4. Integration	17-26	Interfaces implemented per design	Technical Consultant
5. Testing and training	27-31	UAT complete, 46 staff trained on site	Training Manager
6. Go-live and support	32-35	Cutover, 3 weeks on-site support	Project Manager

The team comprises a Project Manager, Principal Consultant, Migration Specialist, Technical Consultant and Training Manager, drawn from our public libraries practice. All five have worked on at least eight prior library replacements. Training is delivered on site at each branch, which our experience shows produces materially better adoption than remote delivery.

4. Commercial Proposal

Our pricing sits mid-range for this competition and reflects a mature product with a long support history rather than a development programme.

One-off implementation charges	Amount
Project initiation and design	\$30,000
Licence and platform setup	\$96,000
Development and customisation	\$64,000
Data migration	\$48,000
Integration services	\$18,000
Training and change management	\$12,000
Total one-off charges	\$268,000

Recurring annual charges	Amount
Hosting	\$28,000
Support and maintenance	\$30,000
Account management	\$4,000
Total per year	\$62,000
Total cost of ownership	\$268,000 + 3 x \$62,000 = \$454,000

Figures are quoted over a 3 year contract term and exclude sales tax.

Commercial assumptions:

- Integration services are provided against an allowance; work exceeding the allowance following the estate survey is charged at day rate
- Training delivered on site at all twelve branches, included
- Legacy data supplied in any readable format; we will handle transformation
- Annual charges subject to CPI review from year four
- Prices exclude applicable sales tax

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

Orbit Digital holds ISO 27001 and ISO 9001 certification, both audited within the last twelve months. Member data is encrypted at rest and in transit, held in-country, and access is controlled through role-based permissions aligned to library job roles. Audit logging covers member record changes, fine waivers and privileged administrative actions.

We carry out an annual penetration test of the platform and share the summary with clients. Our data processing terms, retention schedule and breach notification procedure are provided in Annex D and have been accepted without amendment by 58 public sector clients.

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Integration scope larger than allowance	Medium	Estate survey in phase 1; variation agreed before work proceeds
Legacy data anomalies	Low	19 prior migrations from this product family; known anomalies catalogued
Branch staff availability for training	Medium	On-site delivery scheduled around branch rotas

6. Support Model, Experience and References

Support is provided 08:00 to 18:00 Monday to Friday by our UK-based library support desk, staffed by people who have worked in libraries. Priority 1 response is one hour. A named account manager is assigned to the Service and meets quarterly. Out-of-hours support is available as a chargeable option.

Orbit Digital employs 310 staff, 55 of them in the public libraries practice. Our average client relationship is 11 years and our client retention rate over the past decade is 94 per cent. References, all of whom have agreed to site visits:

- Marlow District Libraries, 16 branches, 240,000 members, delivered 2023, migrated from the same product family as the Service, 40 miles from Greenfield
- Calder Heath Library Service, 11 branches, delivered 2021, client since 2004
- Stanmore Unitary Authority, 9 branches, delivered 2020, client since 1999
- Brookvale Libraries, 7 branches, delivered 2019, client since 2011